INP Welcome Day

Lab Fit Finder

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Frequent PI guidance ↔ Independent project development
Predictable, quick results ↔ Ambitious, high-risk projects
Focused research scope ↔ Broad resources/opportunities

Research Ecosystem

Close-Guided Focus (C) ↔ Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Supportive feedback ↔ Direct, critical feedback
Social/cooperative ↔ Competitive/high-standard

Lab Culture & Motivation

Relational & Sustainable (R) ↔ Performance & Intensity (P)

Defined hours/expectations ↔ Flexibility in time/location
Regular meetings/deadlines ↔ Self-paced work

Work Rhythm

Structured Rhythm (S) ↔ Flexible Autonomy (F)

Research Ecosystem

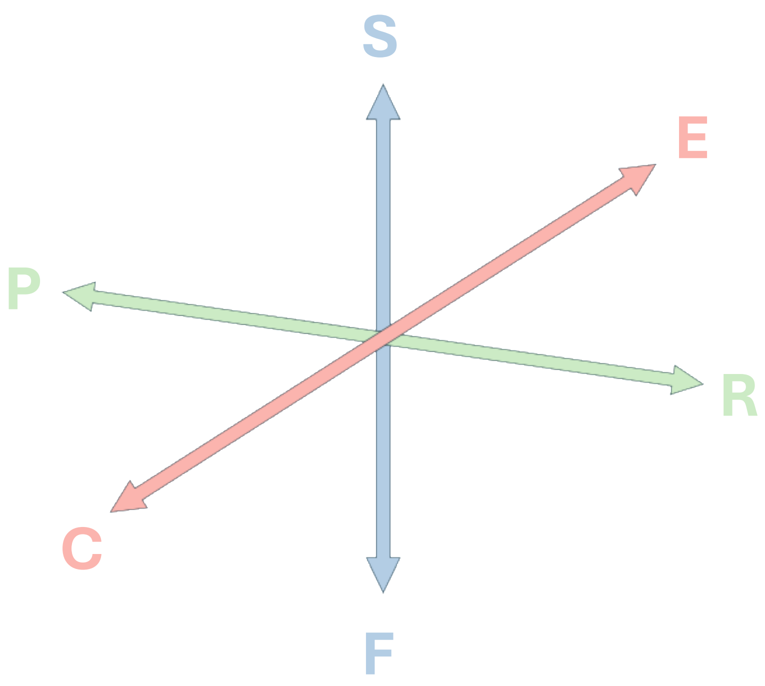
Close-Guided Focus (C)
vs
Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Lab Culture & Motivation

Relational & Sustainable (R)
vs
Performance & Intensity (P)

Work Rhythm

Structured Rhythm (S)
vs
Flexible Autonomy (F)



ERS
The Networked Builder

ERF
The Collaborative Explorer

EPS
The Structured Striver

EPF
The Independent Accelerator

CRS
The Supported Apprentice

CRF
The Reflective Specialist

CPS
The Focused Achiever

CPF
The Agile Specialist

Sample Questions

Progress 0 / 16 answered

1

LEFT

I prefer frequent check-ins and direct feedback so I know I am on the right track.

RIGHT

I prefer having enough time to work things out independently, even if progress is slower at first.

Strongly left | Lean left | In between | Lean right | Strongly right

2

LEFT

I grow most from direct, critical feedback.

RIGHT

I do better when my mentor first tries to understand and encourage me.

Strongly left | Lean left | In between | Lean right | Strongly right

3

LEFT

I work better when there are fairly consistent

RIGHT

I work better when I can adjust my working hours based

Sample Result

YOUR LAB FIT PROFILE

The Collaborative Explorer

ERF

You may thrive with broad scientific freedom, a supportive lab culture, and enough flexibility to manage your work in your own way.

Research Ecosystem

Close-Guided Focus **30%** | **70%** Expansive Ecosystem

Close-Guided Focus | Expansive Ecosystem

You lean toward expansive ecosystem (70% vs 30%).

Lab Culture & Motivation

Relational & Sustainable **70%** | **30%** Performance & Intensity

Relational & Sustainable | Performance & Intensity

You lean toward relational & sustainable (70% vs 30%).

Work Rhythm

Structured Rhythm **40%** | **60%** Flexible Autonomy

Structured Rhythm | Flexible Autonomy

You lean toward flexible autonomy (60% vs 40%).

Not

Core interpretation

You appear drawn to environments that offer room to explore, access to many resources, and the freedom to shape how you work. At the same time, you are likely to value a humane and collaborative culture. A strong fit may be a well-resourced lab that gives trainees independence without making them feel invisible.

Best-fit lab

- Broad, collaborative research program
- Strong resources with meaningful trainee autonomy
- Supportive and psychologically safe lab culture
- Flexible scheduling and outcome-focused expectations

Likely strengths

- You may be especially comfortable exploring new directions and connecting ideas across projects.
- Flexibility can support creativity and sustained motivation.
- You may contribute well to collaborative, non-hierarchical environments.

Blind spots / risks

- Autonomy can become neglect if feedback is too infrequent.
- A broad lab may offer so many possibilities that progress becomes diffuse.
- Without self-created structure, long exploratory projects may drift.

How to make the fit work

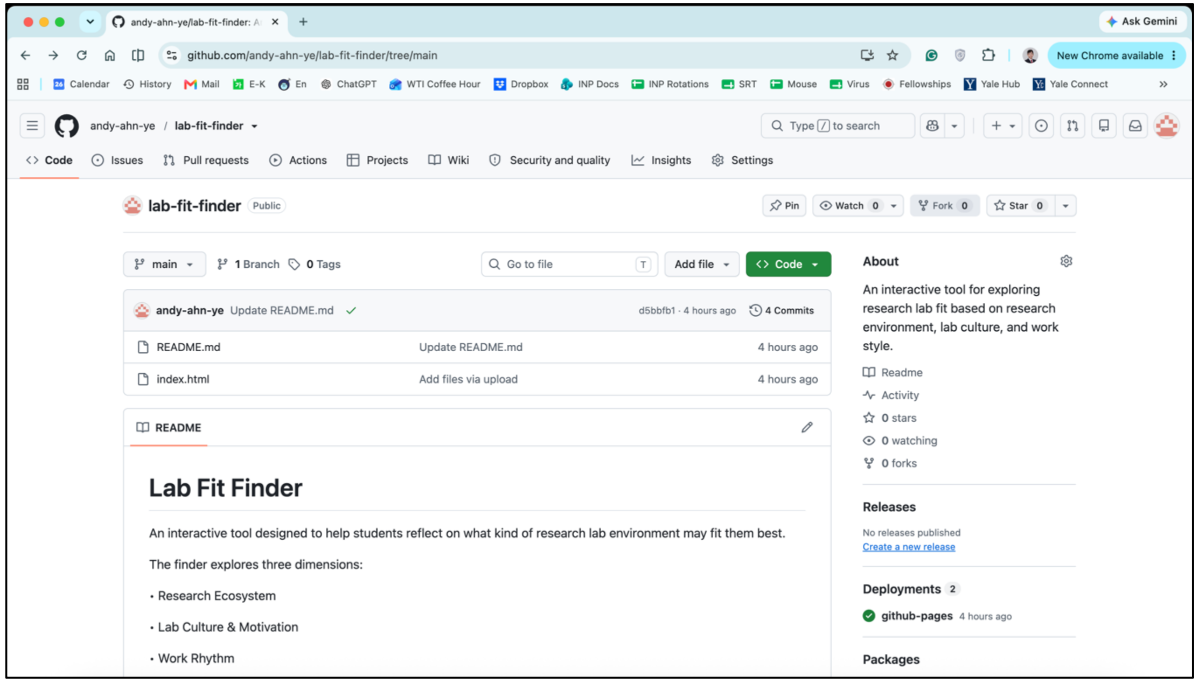
- Create your own milestones even when the lab gives you substantial freedom.
- Seek feedback before you feel completely stuck.
- Choose a lab where independence is paired with accessible support.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How much freedom do students have to initiate or change project directions?
- What happens when a trainee has gone several weeks without clear progress?
- How flexible are working hours and meeting schedules?

Built as an HTML-based app

Deploy with GitHub Pages



➔ Anyone can use it directly without installing anything.

A Few Final Thoughts

1. Use the result as a starting point, not a definitive answer.

Research topics and other factors also matter when choosing a lab.
Your preferences may change over time.

2. Again, welcome to INP!

INP has wonderful people and abundant resources.
Make the most of this environment to develop your scientific knowledge,
experimental and computational skills, and soft skills such as communication and resilience.
Let’s learn and grow together throughout our PhD journey!

https://andy-ahn-ye.github.io/lab-fit-finder/

Questions?

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1) ERS – The Networked Builder

Close-Guided Focus (C) vs Expansive Ecosystem (E)	Relational & Sustainable (R) vs Performance & Intensity (P)	Structured Rhythm (S) vs Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear comfortable using a wide scientific ecosystem—multiple methods, collaborators, and project directions—but you are likely to benefit from a lab culture that is humane and a work rhythm that provides regular checkpoints. Your best fit may be a larger or highly collaborative lab that has strong systems for mentoring rather than leaving trainees to navigate everything alone.

Best-fit lab

- Broad research program with strong funding, tools, and collaborators
- Clear mentoring systems or reliable senior-trainee support
- Collaborative rather than highly competitive culture
- Regular meetings, milestones, or other forms of structure

Likely strengths

- You may be able to take advantage of broad opportunities without losing sight of relationships.
- Structure can help you convert a large number of possibilities into concrete progress.
- You may work well across people, methods, and projects.

Blind spots / risks

- A very large lab may still feel impersonal if support systems are weak.
- Too many opportunities can become distracting when priorities are not clear.
- You may rely on external structure when a project becomes unusually open-ended.

How to make the fit work

- Look for large or collaborative labs that have explicit mentoring routines, not just strong resources.
- Ask for clear near-term milestones when taking on broad or ambitious projects.
- Build relationships with senior trainees as well as the PI.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How are students mentored when the PI is not directly available?
- How often do trainees receive feedback on progress and direction?
- How easy is it to collaborate across projects or methods in the lab?

2) ERF – The Collaborative Explorer

Close-Guided Focus (C)
vs
Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Relational & Sustainable (R)
vs
Performance & Intensity (P)

Structured Rhythm (S)
vs
Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear drawn to environments that offer room to explore, access to many resources, and the freedom to shape how you work. At the same time, you are likely to value a humane and collaborative culture. A strong fit may be a well-resourced lab that gives trainees independence without making them feel invisible.

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- Autonomy can become neglect if feedback is too infrequent.
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How to make the fit work

- Create your own milestones even when the lab gives you substantial freedom.
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3) EPS – The Structured Striver

Close-Guided Focus (C) vs Expansive Ecosystem (E)	Relational & Sustainable (R) vs Performance & Intensity (P)	Structured Rhythm (S) vs Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You seem comfortable with intensity, high standards, and a broad research ecosystem, but you may perform best when goals and checkpoints are explicit. A strong fit could be a demanding, well-resourced lab with a clear performance culture and enough organizational structure to keep ambitious work on track.

Best-fit lab

- High-resource, high-performance research environment
- Clear milestones and regular progress review
- Access to ambitious projects and strong collaborators
- Culture where direct feedback is normal and expectations are explicit

Likely strengths

- You may respond well to demanding goals and ambitious scientific opportunities.
- Structure can help you make efficient use of a large lab ecosystem.
- You may tolerate pressure better than trainees who need a gentler culture.

Blind spots / risks

- Strong performance pressure can gradually become unsustainable.
- External expectations may crowd out your own scientific priorities.
- You may stay in an intense environment longer than is healthy because it feels productive.

How to make the fit work

- Distinguish productive challenge from chronic overload.
- Use structure as a tool, but keep developing your own research judgment.
- Clarify which expectations are essential and which are simply lab norms.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How are expectations communicated and evaluated?
- What does a normal week look like for trainees in practice?
- How much freedom do students have within ambitious lab-wide projects?

4) EPF – The Independent Accelerator

Close-Guided Focus (C)
vs
Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Relational & Sustainable (R)
vs
Performance & Intensity (P)

Structured Rhythm (S)
vs
Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear comfortable with scientific uncertainty, independence, and high expectations. A large or opportunity-rich environment may suit you especially well if it rewards initiative and gives you room to pursue ambitious questions. Your main challenge is making sure freedom does not become isolation and intensity does not become invisible overwork.

Best-fit lab

- Resource-rich lab with substantial intellectual freedom
- Ambitious research culture that rewards initiative
- Flexible work structure
- Strong opportunities for collaboration, methods, and high-impact projects

Likely strengths

- You may be highly self-directed and opportunity-seeking.
- You may handle ambitious, uncertain projects well.
- You can potentially make exceptional use of a broad lab ecosystem.

Blind spots / risks

- You may receive too little calibration because you seem independent.
- Flexibility plus ambition can make overwork difficult to notice.
- A competitive environment may become isolating if support is weak.

How to make the fit work

- Build a deliberate feedback network instead of relying only on the PI.
- Set limits around intensity before a project becomes all-consuming.
- Ask for strategic calibration even when you do not need step-by-step guidance.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How much freedom do trainees have to build their own scientific direction?
- How do independent students get feedback when they need it?
- How are authorship, ownership, and competition handled across projects?

5) CRS – The Supported Apprentice

Close-Guided Focus (C) vs Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Relational & Sustainable (R) vs Performance & Intensity (P)

Structured Rhythm (S) vs Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear to value direct access to mentors, a clear research path, psychological safety, and enough external structure to maintain momentum. A smaller or more hands-on lab may be especially effective for you, particularly if the PI is invested in training and expectations are clear.

Best-fit lab

- Small or focused lab with accessible PI mentorship
- Frequent feedback and clear research direction
- Supportive, close-knit culture
- Regular meetings and explicit milestones

Likely strengths

- You may learn rapidly when guidance is close and consistent.
- Trust and structure can help you build confidence while developing technical depth.
- You may be especially effective in environments with clear expectations.

Blind spots / risks

- You may become overly dependent on one mentor.
- A narrow lab can limit exposure to alternative methods or scientific perspectives.
- Independence may develop more slowly if the PI makes most major decisions.

How to make the fit work

- Use close mentorship as a foundation for gradually increasing independence.
- Ask for opportunities to make decisions rather than only execute them.
- Build relationships outside the lab to broaden your scientific network.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How frequently does the PI meet one-on-one with trainees?
- How does student independence increase over time?
- What opportunities are available to collaborate outside the lab?

6) CRF – The Reflective Specialist

Close-Guided Focus (C)
vs
Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Relational & Sustainable (R)
vs
Performance & Intensity (P)

Structured Rhythm (S)
vs
Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear to value a close and humane mentoring environment, but you also want room to manage your own schedule and workflow. A smaller lab with an engaged PI may fit well if the mentor provides direction without micromanaging how every hour of work is organized.

Best-fit lab

- Focused small or mid-size lab
- Accessible and supportive PI
- Clear scientific direction with flexible daily workflow
- Trust-based culture that allows autonomy without neglect

Likely strengths

- You may combine deep training with thoughtful self-management.
- A strong mentor relationship can support both confidence and independence.
- Flexible routines may help you sustain focus over long periods.

Blind spots / risks

- You may depend heavily on mentor fit because the relationship is central to the environment.
- Too little day-to-day structure can still create drift.
- You may avoid harder feedback if support becomes overly protective.

How to make the fit work

- Clarify which decisions belong to you and which require mentor input.
- Create your own routines even when the lab is flexible.
- Seek mentors who can be supportive and candid at the same time.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How available is the PI when a trainee needs guidance?
- How flexible are schedules and working locations in practice?
- How does the PI balance support with critical feedback?

7) CPS – The Focused Achiever

Close-Guided Focus (C)
vs
Expansive Ecosystem (E)

Relational & Sustainable (R)
vs
Performance & Intensity (P)

Structured Rhythm (S)
vs
Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear comfortable with direct feedback and demanding expectations, but you also value close guidance and a defined path. A hands-on lab with an ambitious PI may suit you particularly well if the culture is intense but organized rather than chaotic.

Best-fit lab

- Focused research program with direct PI involvement
- High standards and frequent critical feedback
- Clear milestones and structured expectations
- Strong technical training

Likely strengths

- You may improve quickly under rigorous, hands-on mentorship.
- Clear direction can help you turn high expectations into concrete progress.
- You may be comfortable in technically demanding environments.

Blind spots / risks

- You may become highly dependent on the PI's priorities.
- A controlling mentor can limit the development of your scientific identity.
- Intensity plus structure can become rigid or exhausting.

How to make the fit work

- Ask for increasing ownership as your skills grow.
- Learn to separate useful criticism from unnecessary pressure.
- Make sure you understand the broader scientific reasoning behind assigned tasks.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How much of a student's project direction is decided by the PI?
- How does the lab respond when experiments or milestones are missed?
- At what point are trainees expected to develop independent ideas?

8) CPF – The Agile Specialist

Close-Guided Focus (C) vs Expansive Ecosystem (E)	Relational & Sustainable (R) vs Performance & Intensity (P)	Structured Rhythm (S) vs Flexible Autonomy (F)

Core interpretation

You appear to value focused training and rigorous feedback, but you do not necessarily want rigid daily supervision. A strong fit may be an intellectually intense small or mid-size lab where the PI is scientifically engaged while trusting trainees to manage their own workflow.

Best-fit lab

- Small or mid-size lab with strong PI engagement
- Direct, rigorous feedback
- Focused scientific program
- Flexible day-to-day work style

Likely strengths

- You may combine technical depth with independent execution.
- You can potentially use direct feedback without needing constant monitoring.
- Flexible workflow may help you respond efficiently to experimental demands.

Blind spots / risks

- A close mentor may become controlling if boundaries around autonomy are unclear.
- High expectations can make flexible work expand into all hours.
- A narrow scientific program may limit breadth if you do not seek outside exposure.

How to make the fit work

- Be explicit about when you want feedback and when you need space.
- Protect flexible scheduling from turning into constant availability.
- Build collaborations outside the lab to broaden your scientific perspective.

Questions to ask when choosing a lab

- How does the PI distinguish guidance from micromanagement?
- Are trainees evaluated by outcomes, hours, or both?
- How easy is it to collaborate beyond the lab's core research area?